



STATE ANGLING TICKET FOR TOURISTS STUDY MATERIAL FOR THE E- LEARNING KNOWLEDGE TEST AND GENERAL GUIDE

CORRECTED, UPDATED EDITION

2023



The main objective of this electronic publication is to help angling tourists pass the online knowledge test required for a state angling ticket for tourists to be issued. However, it also includes essential information which is advisable for anglers to be aware of when fishing, covering the detailed rules of angling, the state angling examination, types of angling documents, basic fishing methods and the expected ethical conduct.

1. KNOWLEDGE OF FISHERIES MANAGEMENT AND FISH PROTECTION LAWS

Act CII of 2013 on fisheries management and fish protection (‘the Fish Act’) regulates fisheries management activities and activities related to the protection of fish and their habitats in fishery waters and on their waterside, and in fish production facilities in the territory of Hungary, as well as the rights and obligations of persons carrying out or influencing these activities – in particular the operators of waters and water facilities suitable for fisheries management, and users of fishery waters and their waterside on other grounds, water users –, the functions and powers associated with the administration of fisheries management, and the conditions for trading in fish and fish products.

As regards protected fish and other protected useful aquatic animals, the provisions of the *Fish Act* must be applied except where otherwise provided for in the *Act on nature conservation*; that is protected species do not fall under the scope of the *Fish Act* in all respects.

1.1. Documents authorising the catching of fish

For angling in fishery waters and in fish production facilities, catching fish and activities aiming at catching fish are subject to holding a valid Hungarian Angler’s Card (which replaces the previous paper angling card) issued by the Angling Association and confirming membership of the Association as well as the Combined State Angling Document consisting of a state angling ticket and a catch log (‘Angling Documents’) or **a tourist state angling ticket and the accompanying catch log, and require compliance with the provisions of the Fish Act and its implementing legal act, Decree No. 133/2013 of 29 December 2013 of the Minister of Rural Development laying down certain rules of fisheries management and fish protection (‘the Decree’).**

To obtain a state angling ticket for tourists, it is not necessary to apply for a Hungarian Angler’s Card and become a member of the Angling Association.

Angling tickets, irrespective of type, are not transferable. One person can only apply for one ticket of each type per year except for tickets that are lost or destroyed.

In **registered** fishery waters, angling activities **also require a local ticket issued by the fishing rights holder.**

It is worth noting that, *besides catching fish, the collection of any other useful aquatic animals (e.g. specimens of lake fly larvae, non-protected bivalve and crustacean species) is also subject to holding documents authorising the catching of fish, and their use as bait is subject to holding documents authorising angling.*



State angling tickets or tourist state angling tickets cannot be issued to anyone who has been fined for contravening fish protection rules while serving the ban imposed by the penalising decision of the fisheries authority. On the expiry of the fisheries authority's ban, a state angling ticket or a tourist state angling ticket may only be obtained after the fishing fine has been paid.

Anglers having a state angling ticket for tourists and failing to comply with the obligation of submitting the data of the catch log (having to report the catch within 30 days of the expiry of the validity of the ticket, which primarily means uploading through the electronic system) will be banned from obtaining a state angling ticket for tourists for the subsequent calendar year.

1.1.1. State angling ticket for tourists

The state angling ticket for tourists can be obtained on the website of the HORINFO angling information system after passing the online knowledge test. This involves printing the angling document after obtaining the ticket because the catch log must be kept in the way required by the relevant legislation.

Holders of a **state angling ticket for tourists** are allowed to use **1 (one) fishing set** (comprised of at least a rod and line) – **equipped with not more than 2 (two) hooks with at most three prongs each** – together with, provided the local angling rules permit, **1 (one) live bait lifting net not larger than 1 m².**

State angling tickets for tourists may be obtained for a fee and are **valid until the end of the 90th day after the date of issue. In registered fishery waters, the tourist state angling ticket entitles the holder to angle during its validity period only if accompanied by a valid local ticket.** State angling tickets for tourists may be obtained via the Angling Association's online sales and angling information system (HORINFO), through which basic knowledge of the rules and species can be demonstrated.

1.1.2. Catch log

The catch log forms an integral part of the tourist state angling ticket or the document combining the state angling ticket and catch log ('the Combined State Angling Document'), and is used to record the days on which angling was carried out and to register the fish caught.

Pursuant to the relevant legislation, the catch log issued together with the tourist state angling ticket must be sent to the Angling Association within 30 days after the validity of the tourist state angling ticket expires. Sending also means uploading through the online HORINFO angling information system.



If anglers fail to comply with the obligation to submit the catch log, they may not apply for a tourist state angling ticket in the subsequent year.

When commencing angling, anglers must record the start date of angling in the calendar section of the catch log. When angling from a boat, commencing angling means the departure of the boat.

Fish caught and intended to be kept that are of a species which is subject to a restriction on the quantity that may be caught must be recorded in the catch log immediately after removing the hook. Fish that are not intended to be kept and are released immediately after being caught do not need to be recorded in the log. The quantity of fish species that are not subject to a restriction on the number caught must be recorded, expressed as total weight, in the catch log when angling has finished but before leaving the waterside. *The log may need to be updated several times a day if the angler leaves the registered fishery water during the day; that is the recording must be repeated if the angler again catches fish species not subject to a number restriction when angling on the same day.*

1.1.3. Local ticket

Today electronic local (area) tickets can be bought for most angling waters through the HORINFO angling information system. An electronically issued local ticket does not need to be printed unless required by the fisheries operator, but being able to provide proof of authorisation to fish (i.e. the existence of the local ticket) via an IT device at any time while angling is the responsibility of every angler.

In order to provide angling opportunities, local tickets may be issued to anglers by one or more fishing rights holders. In registered fishery waters, the local tickets that may be issued by the fishing rights holder in that area only confer entitlement to angle

- **together with a state angling ticket and a catch log, or**
- **together with a tourist state angling ticket and a catch log.**

The fishing rights holder must indicate on the local ticket, – among other details – any restrictions on catches imposed by the rights holder under local rules that are stricter than those laid down in the relevant legislation, any favourable or exemptive differences regarding the size range of the different fish species that may be caught and their closed seasons laid down by the fisheries authority, and a detailed description of the boundaries of the area or areas closed to fishing and the period of their closure with which anglers must comply.

For the sake of traceability, local tickets must be consecutively numbered without interruption and have a master copy, and must also bear the abbreviated fishery water code(s) of the registered fishery water(s) covered by the validity of the local ticket.

It is always advisable to check the information on the local ticket, especially the local angling regulations, before starting to fish, because registered fishery waters may be subject to stricter angling rules than those laid down by law. Before starting to fish, it is necessary



to check the period of time the local ticket is valid for (the validity of the electronic local ticket starts 30 minutes after the time of its issue at the earliest), any restrictions on catches specified by the fishing rights holder that differ from those provided for by law, and any divergences regarding the size ranges of the different fish species that may be caught and their closed seasons approved by the fisheries authority of the county government office in the fish management plan for the fishing rights holder. The detailed description of the boundaries of the area or areas closed to fishing and the period of their closure are contained on the local ticket or an appendix thereto.

If administrative, infraction or criminal proceedings are brought against an angler in relation to angling or fish catching, the local ticket confiscated by the official fishing attendant dealing with the incident may be retained by the fishing rights holder until the proceedings have been finally concluded, and may be returned or withdrawn depending on the outcome of the proceedings.

Compulsory angler registration and the Hungarian Angler's Card

Since 1 January 2019, valid angler registration has been a prerequisite for issuing state angling tickets and – in order to make administration and registration simpler and faster – for the application for the angling examination. Registration is based on the unchanging nature of the data on the tax card (the tax card is essential for successful registration), which has enabled the creation of a much-needed, long-term national register of anglers. The IT system is able to store and manage data on state angling examinations, association memberships and angling documents, which will simplify the lives of anglers in all respects and also filter out and prevent potential abuses. To register child anglers, due to legal requirements on legal capacity, a parent or relative must register in the system first and then the child can be registered by selecting “own child” on the web interface. If the relative does not fish, it is not necessary for them to apply for an Angler's Card.

For people who do not have a tax card, a certificate issued by the National Tax and Customs Administration is an acceptable substitute document. Foreigners may register in the system by uploading the image of a valid identity document with a photograph (passport, ID card).

Part of the registration process is the application for a Hungarian Angler's Card ('the Card'), which replaces the previous paper angling card. For child anglers and foreign anglers, the Card is not compulsory, but one may be applied for if so desired. The completed Card will be sent by registered mail by the producer to the postal address provided (at present, this is only possible for postal addresses in Hungary). The Card is valid for 5 years and also entitles the holder to special offers by partner companies.

State Angling Examination

It is not necessary to pass a state angling examination to get a tourist state angling ticket, but passing an electronic test which checks the angler's essential knowledge of angling is a prerequisite. This study material provides help in passing the knowledge test.

Electronically supported state angling examinations can be taken free of charge at the location and on the examination day announced by the angling association or angling organisation involved (county or regional angling associations). The angling organisation involved in the examination must organise at least one state angling examination every two months. An examination taken in a member state of the European Union, in another state which is party to the Agreement on the European Economic Area or in a state whose nationals enjoy the same status as nationals of a state which is party to the Agreement on the European Economic Area under an international treaty concluded between the European Community and its member states and a state which is not party to the Agreement on the European Economic Area will be considered equivalent to this examination.



The angling organisation authorised to hold the angling examination may organise a preparatory course subject to a fee but may not oblige applicants for the angling examination to take that preparatory course. The fee for this course may not exceed HUF 1,000 per lesson and HUF 4,000 in all. The course length must be at least two lessons. The electronically supported **angling examination may only be applied for after the successful completion of angler registration (having 'active' registration status).**

The angling organisation involved in the examination must publish the exact examination location and date in the HORINFO angling information system at least 3 days before the examination is held **and notify the angling association of the dates.** The announced angling examination must be created in the HORINFO angling information system by the end of the 3rd calendar day (23:59) preceding the day of the examination at the latest. Anglers can apply for the angling examination in the HORINFO system in the menu of the personal profile created during registration by selecting the most suitable examination location and date.

After a successful state angling examination, **the HORINFO system will automatically issue a state angling examination certificate** with the contents published on the website of the fisheries authority, which will be given to the examinee by the examiner on request. The data of the issued state angling examination certificates will be recorded in the angling association's IT system of in the format specified by the fisheries authority.

The angling association will **replace lost or destroyed state angling examination certificates** using the data in its records **free of charge without having to repeat the examination.** Exemption from the angling examination must be credibly proved to the State Angling Examination Board by submitting a certificate stating the grounds for the exemption, the content of which is determined by the angling association.

State angling ticket and catch log, i.e. the Combined State Angling Document

The Combined State Angling Document, often called the state angling ticket and catch log, is issued by the angling association and the angling organisation entrusted by it.

The organisation issuing the state angling ticket keeps records of the documents issued by it. Issuance to anglers is usually through angling associations and angling clubs. The state angling ticket confers entitlement to angle. The basic national rules of angling are specified by the provisions of the Decree.

A state angling ticket may be issued to natural persons who have a valid angling registration and can prove at the time of issue that they have passed the state angling examination (or, in the case of exemption specified in the Fish Act, proof of this is required) or present a previously valid state angling ticket and a valid angling association membership for the year in question. The angler must provide proof of having passed the state angling examination by presenting a state angling examination certificate.

Natural persons who are not Hungarian citizens, have no registered address in Hungary and have not passed the Hungarian state angling examination, i.e. foreign natural persons, may obtain the state angling ticket by presenting an angling licence or document issued in another country.

A fee must be paid to obtain a state angling ticket, which is valid from the date of issue until 31 January of the following year. A state angling ticket may also be issued if the catch log is submitted after the deadline, or if it is incorrectly completed or not submitted. At such times the fee is twice the current price (excluding the catch log fee), or, for persons exempt from the fee, except for child anglers, the price of the state angling ticket.

For child anglers, i.e. children from the age of 3 and over until the year in which they reach their 15th birthday by 31 December, a state angling ticket can be simply obtained free of charge and without any examination or membership requirements.

People with a mental disability whose legal representative presents proof of their condition to the State Angling Examination Board are exempted from taking the state angling examination, as are the blind or partially sighted who can likewise demonstrate their condition.



People with a mental disability exempted from taking the state angling examination and holding documents entitling them to fish may fish only in the continuous presence of a person over 18 years of age who holds a state angling examination.

In addition to child anglers who are not members of an angling association, people who are 70 years of age or over, people with a mental disability whose legal representative submits documents proving their condition, people with a locomotor or hearing disability, and the blind or partially sighted who present documents proving their condition are exempt from paying the state angling ticket fee.

Child anglers and people with mental disability holding a state angling ticket may use one rod and line equipped with one hook with at most three prongs. Child anglers may only fish under the supervision of an adult.

The theft, destruction or loss of the state angling ticket and the catch log must be reported immediately by the holder at the distribution point of the angling organisation entrusted by the angling association where the document in question was issued, or, if the distribution of the state angling ticket at that place has ceased in the meantime, to the angling association.

1.2. Angling rules

Persons pursuing fish catching activities in non-registered fishery waters must be able to present either their tourist state angling ticket together with the accompanying catch log, or their state angling ticket and catch log (Combined State Angling Document) together with their Hungarian Angler's Card issued by the Angling Association.

When angling in registered fishery waters, anglers – in addition to the above – must also have a valid local ticket issued by the fishing rights holder.

When fishing, anglers must be able to show the documents authorising them to fish, together with an official document with a photograph proving identity (identity card/driver's licence/passport).

Upon request, anglers must show and hand over their angling documents (Hungarian Angler's Card and state angling ticket or tourist state angling ticket and catch log) to the fisheries authority, national fishing inspectors, fishing rights holders, official fishing attendants, field guards, nature conservation rangers, community fishing attendants, and any representatives authorised to conduct checks on behalf of the law enforcement authority.

Catching fish and pursuing activities for the purpose of or suitable for catching fish in fishery waters without holding a valid tourist state angling ticket or state angling ticket and being unable to show the necessary documents is regarded as illegal angling.

Catching fish and pursuing activities for that purpose in registered fishery waters without holding a valid local ticket authorising angling issued by the fishing rights holder is considered illegal angling.



- *When angling, under the general rules of angling specified by the Decree, the prohibition on catching certain indigenous fish species in given calendar periods (species-specific closed seasons), and the provisions on*
- *the catchable size ranges (size restrictions) for each fish species,*
- *and the total allowable catch for each fish species per day and per year (quantitative angling restrictions) must be complied with.*

Fishing rights holders may specify restrictions differing from the above for the registered fishery water operated by them provided that those restrictions have been approved by the fisheries authority as part of the fish management plan. Such restrictions must be indicated on the local ticket.

Operators, either persons or organisations, holding the fishing rights of the registered fishery water may establish local angling regulations, which must be developed in accordance with the legislation in force. Local angling regulations may not establish less stringent rules than those laid down in the Fish Act and the Decree (e.g. the minimum size of catchable carp may not be set at 20 centimetres) without the approval of the authority. However, in the interests of environmental protection and targeted, nature-oriented education, local rules may be laid down for a specific water, which the angling organisation is responsible for enforcing. Possible sanctions include the termination or suspension of the membership of persons infringing the local angling regulations, the withdrawal or temporary withdrawal of their local ticket, and, if the local angling regulations so provide, a ban on issuing local tickets for up to 5 years.

1.3. Prohibited equipment and methods

The use of any fishing equipment or methods that may damage or endanger fish populations and their habitats is forbidden.

In fishery waters, the use of all fishing equipment that does not ensure the humane release of the specimens of a fish species living in the given habitat affected by a closed season is forbidden during the calendar period covered by that closed season.

In fishery waters, the use of any fishing equipment or device and methods which, given the actual water level, block longitudinally or transversely more than half of the bed of the running or standing water or of the temporary connections creating fish passages between them is prohibited.

Other **prohibited fishing equipment and methods** in fishery waters include

- the use or possession of fishing equipment operating on the basis of the physiological effects of electricity on fish in or at the waterside of fishery waters,
- the use of toxic or narcotic substances,*
- the use of explosives,*
- the use of piercing tools,*



- the use of scuba diving harpoons or other scuba diving devices suitable for catching fish,*
- the use of snagging,*
- the use of loop-snaring fishing methods; and stroke-hauling or snatching or spring-operated impaling methods,*
- the use of gillnets, and
- the attempted use of any of the above methods.

*use is also forbidden in fish production facilities

The use of direct current electronic fishing devices may be authorised by the minister. The licence may only be granted to a person qualified as an electronic fishing device operator.

The gillnet is not considered prohibited gear or a prohibited method when the fisheries authority grants a licence for the use of such a net to assess fish stocks or for ecological or selective fishing.

1.4. Closed seasons and restrictions

The minister is empowered to regulate by special decree the catchable size range of indigenous fish, prohibitions on catching protected fish, closed seasons and restrictions on the number of fish that may be caught.

Fish species, jawless fish species and other useful aquatic animals listed in *Decree No. 13/2001 of 9 May 2001 of the Minister of Environment on protected and specially protected plant and animal species, on specially protected caves, and on the publication of plant and animal species of importance in terms of nature conservation in the European Community* must not be caught. If this rule is violated, sanctions may be imposed on the angler under nature conservation legislation.

Therefore, it is imperative for anglers to know that in Hungary **species protected under a nature conservation scheme** include

- jawless fish, i.e. the three species of lamprey occurring in Hungary,
- the following species of fish:
 - indigenous sturgeon species (great sturgeon, starry sturgeon, Russian sturgeon, bastard sturgeon),
 - Danube roach, common dace, barbel species, a number of small fish species, i.e. European mudminnow, Eurasian minnow, belica, spirlin, European bitterling, all 4 species of gudgeon and all 4 species of loach,
 - several small predatory fish, i.e. both bullhead species, schraetzer, Danube ruffe, zingel and Danube streber,
 - and, lastly, certain species that rarely occur in national waters, i.e. Black Sea roach, souffia, grayling and Danube salmon.

There are also some species of fish that are not protected **but must not be caught: sterlet, crucian carp and ruffe.**



(It is worth noting that, of Hungary's five indigenous sturgeon species, four are protected and the fifth must not be caught, while the situation is similar for the three species of ruffe, two of which are protected and the third must not be caught.)

Anglers intending to collect other aquatic animals should also know that **many aquatic animals** such as many dragonfly, mayfly, stonefly, and caddisfly species, both medicinal leech species, and indigenous decapods, i.e. noble crayfish, Danube crayfish, and stone crayfish, are **protected**, and therefore **only persons having the necessary special fishery operator's licences who are able to definitely identify the species they wish to collect should start collecting useful aquatic animals.**

All anglers should know that all amphibian and reptile species in Hungary, and all bird species, with the exception of a few huntable bird species, and the vast majority of mammals are protected. The conservation of Hungary's protected natural assets is the common responsibility of everyone.

The fisheries authority may, in special cases, grant temporary exemption from the prohibition on catching crucian carp and sterlet at the request of the fishery rights holder. (No exemption can be granted in the period between 1 March and 31 May, while exemptions may be granted for at least 50 cm sterlet specimens and at least 20 cm crucian carp specimens. The regulations on indigenous fish species protected by a restriction on the daily number of fish that may be caught apply to these species.)

For understandable reasons, a closed season must also be established for the breeding season of fish that may be caught at other times of the year.

Fish species	Species-specific closed season
pike	1 February to 31 March
asp	1 March to 30 April
perch	1 March to 30 April
zander	1 March to 30 April
Volga pikeperch	1 March to 30 June
ziege	15 April to 31 May
chub	15 April to 31 May
ide	15 April to 31 May
vimba bream	15 April to 31 May
sneep	15 April to 31 May
barbel	15 April to 31 May
common carp	2 May to 31 May
tench	2 May to 15 June
wels catfish	2 May to 15 June
brown trout	1 October to 31 March



Species-specific closed seasons start at 00:00 on the first day and end at 24:00 on the last day. If the first day is a Saturday or a public holiday, the closed season enters into force on the first working day that follows. If the last day is a Saturday or a public holiday, the closed season ends on the last working day directly preceding it.

There are, however, individual, special cases when deviations from the dates of the closed seasons laid down in the relevant legislation are possible or exemptions may be granted.

The **fisheries authority** may, within its remit or at the request of the fishing rights holder, **shorten the closed season** laid down by law **or grant a derogation from it or from the size or quantitative restriction for the fisheries water or part of it and for a specified period.**

The contrary is also possible; that is additional closed seasons, and size or number restrictions may also be introduced, or the closed season may be prolonged.

**Size range and daily allowable catch for indigenous species of fish that may be caught
(local angling regulations may be more restrictive)**

Fish species	Size range of catchable fish	Daily allowable catch
		(number of fish or kg)
pike	at least 40 cm	3 fish
asp	at least 40 cm	3 fish
perch	at least 15 cm	3 kg
zander	at least 30 cm	3 fish
Volga pikeperch	at least 25 cm	3 fish
ziege	at least 20 cm	3 kg
chub	at least 25 cm	3 kg
ide	at least 20 cm	3 kg
vimba bream	at least 20 cm	3 kg
sneep	at least 20 cm	3 kg
barbel	at least 40 cm	3 fish
common carp	at least 30 cm	3 fish
tench	at least 25 cm	3 fish
wels catfish	at least 60 cm	3 fish
brown trout	at least 22 cm	3 fish
burbot	at least 25 cm	3 kg

Accidentally caught specimens of species which are subject to a prohibition and fish which must not be caught due to size or quantitative restrictions must be carefully taken off the hook, or, where this is impossible without injuring the fish, the line must be cut before the mouth and



the fish must be immediately released back into its habitat, even if the specimen is injured, diseased or dead.

In addition to specifying closed seasons and size restrictions, the Decree also lays down that only a set number of specimens of certain fish species subject to size restrictions is allowed to be caught. This is referred to as a number restriction.

Under the Decree, the following **fish species are subject to a number restriction: pike, asp, zander, Volga pikeperch, barbel, common carp, tench, wels catfish and brown trout** and, where the authority allows these species to be caught, sterlet and crucian carp.

In all registered fishery waters, anglers holding a tourist state angling ticket or a state angling ticket are allowed to catch on any one day 2 fish per species subject to a daily number restriction, but a total of not more than 3 such fish. It is forbidden to exchange fish caught with a previously caught fish.

In registered fishery waters, anglers holding a tourist state angling ticket are allowed to catch on any one day a total of 10 kg of indigenous fish species not subject to a daily number restriction except for species of burbot, perch, chub, sneep, vimba bream, ziege and ide, for which the daily allowable catch is at most 3 kg.

In the fishery waters leased by the Hungarian National Angling Association, including waters sublet to angling organisations, as regards species protected by a daily number restriction, anglers holding a tourist state angling ticket are allowed to catch 20 fish per year, which must not weigh more than 30 kilograms. For indigenous fish species not protected by a number restriction, the total allowable catch is 20 kg per year.

In registered fishery waters, anglers holding a state angling ticket are allowed to catch on any one day 3 fish per indigenous species subject to daily number restrictions, and a total of not more than 5 such fish. It is forbidden to exchange fish caught with a previously caught fish.

In fishery waters leased by the angling association, as regards species protected by a number restriction on the daily allowable catch, anglers holding a valid state angling ticket may catch in any one year at most 100 fish but at most a total of 150 kg.

In registered fishery waters, anglers holding a state angling ticket are allowed to catch on any one day a total of 10 kg of indigenous fish species not subject to a daily number restriction except for species of burbot, perch, chub, sneep, vimba bream, ziege and ide, for which the daily total allowable catch is 3 kg.

In the fishery waters leased by the angling association, anglers with a valid state angling ticket are allowed to catch at most 100 kg per year of indigenous fish species not protected by a number restriction.

Anglers under 15 years of age and anglers with a mental disability are allowed to catch a total of 1 fish per day of species subject to a daily number restriction, unless otherwise provided for in the local fishing regulations, and a total of 5 kg per day of indigenous fish species not subject to a daily number restriction, except for species of burbot, perch, chub, sneep, vimba bream, ziege and ide, for which the daily allowable catch is at most 2 kg.

In fishery waters leased by the angling association, child anglers may catch at most 20 fish per year, but not more than 30 kilograms, of species protected by a daily allowable catch number. For indigenous fish species not protected by a number restriction, the total allowable catch is 20 kg per year.



It is important to note that in the vast majority of fishery waters the rules on taking away fish are much stricter than the legal minimum described above. *Just think how much a kilo of zander costs in a market, and a fishing ticket buys you not only the fish but also the experience of angling.*

If an angler catches an indigenous fish not subject to a daily number restriction but which exceeds the weight limit, the angler may keep the fish but must not catch any more indigenous fish not subject to a daily number restriction on that day. The same applies when an angler catches an indigenous fish not subject to an annual number restriction but which exceeds the weight limit applicable to it: the angler may keep the fish but must not catch any more indigenous fish not subject to an annual number restriction in that year.

Torturing caught fish is prohibited. Caught fish must be treated in a way that ensures that the physical injury to them does not exceed the minimum necessary due to the fishing method. Unwanted fish – with the exception of fishing competitions – must be immediately released back into the water. Any fish caught must be either kept alive without causing permanent injury until they are killed or killed immediately. **It is forbidden to keep fish that have been hooked externally and not at the head** (this provision also applies to invasive fish species).

Properly caught fish that are to be taken away **may be removed from the waterside after they have been killed quickly and humanely by the angler.** *In guarded waters that are fenced off and have single-gate access, the fishery operator may require that the fish be kept alive until exit to ensure their potential release.* Fish less than 30 cm long may also be taken away live, but only in containers filled with adequately oxygenated water which minimise stress to the fish.

In order to protect indigenous fish populations, the release of non-indigenous fish (of any origin) into the water and the release of non-indigenous invasive fish back into the water is prohibited. Using non-indigenous fish as bait is only allowed in the registered fishery water where the non-indigenous fish was caught.

In order to protect overwintering fish stocks, fishing rights holders are obliged to examine the prohibition on or restriction of the use of sonar for fishing activities for the calendar year or part of the calendar year in all or part of the registered fishery water(s) over which their rights apply. **The rules of or prohibition** on the use of sonar for fishing activities must be **laid down in the local fishing regulations.**

Anglers must also set an example in all circumstances in the field of environmental protection, which is an added reason why littering is prohibited (an increasing number of local angling regulations prohibit fishing in places where rubbish has been left, so anglers must also set an example by collecting litter). Likewise, cutting down or grubbing up aquatic and waterside vegetation, and destroying or damaging waterside protective structures is forbidden.



2. FISHING CONTROL

2.1. Duties of the official fishing attendants

The duties of the official fishing attendants include guarding the fishery waters operated by the fishing rights holder under the fish management plan, and protecting the fish populations and habitats in those waters.

Official fishing attendants must wear the uniform specified in *Decree No. 70/2012 of 14 December 2012 on the detailed rules of the supply of clothing for persons with law enforcement tasks and armed security guards*. The official badge of the fishing control service must be worn affixed to the button of the left breast pocket of the uniform below the flap of the pocket, or pinned to the same location.

2.2. Concept and legal status of community fishing attendants

In order to enforce the control of fishing more broadly, the Fish Act introduced the concept of the community fishing attendant. At the request of the fishing rights holder, community fishing attendants are appointed by the fisheries authority in the area under its jurisdiction provided that this is justified for controlling fishing and protecting fish populations.

2.3. National Fishing Inspection Service

The National Fishing Inspection Service is operated by the National Food Chain Safety Office and is staffed by national fishing inspectors. National fishing inspectors have national jurisdiction, and the powers of an official fishing attendant and the fisheries authority. The scope of action of national fishing inspectors is not limited to fishery waters and their watersides, but they are also authorised to track fish and fish products. Accordingly, national fishing inspectors may also conduct checks at fish and fish product sales points, and even at private properties where there is good reason.

2.4. Fishery administration

The rules and requirements described above can only be complied with effectively if they are supervised by an authority. The law assigned these tasks to the remit of the fisheries authorities operating at different levels. Accordingly, the implementation of state tasks related to fish management is the responsibility of the minister, the National Food Chain Safety Office, the Pest County Government Office and the other county government offices.

The fisheries authority imposes a fine for contravening fish protection rules on anglers failing to comply with the relevant provisions of the Fish Act.

The lowest and highest amounts of the fine are HUF 10,000 and HUF 500,000 respectively.



In addition to imposing fishing fines, the fisheries authority will also withdraw the state angling ticket or the tourist state angling ticket of non-complying anglers, and specify a period of debarment from obtaining a new ticket.

3. THE MOST IMPORTANT RULES OF ANGLING AND THE RELATED ETHICAL REQUIREMENTS

The ethical rules of angling are the standards of human behaviour that the cultured person, the angler, demonstrates towards others and expects from others. These, as seen above, are now in part enshrined in the country's laws and their infringement is sanctionable, while others remain unwritten norms but are expected to be observed to the same extent as their legal counterparts. The fishing community as a whole is judged by the behaviour of individual anglers at the waterside, thus great attention should be paid to ensuring that these standards of behaviour are met.

Anglers, while relaxing at the waterside and enjoying the experience of catching fish, should always strive to fish in a sporting way, respecting the rules and in harmony with the natural environment. The essence of the recreation of anglers is the calm and tranquillity of the water and the waterside and the pleasing natural environment together with the experience of catching fish, but not of catching fish at any price. In order to achieve this, anglers should avoid shouting, making a noise and operating loud technical equipment and refrain from offensive language and behaviour that is inappropriate for the waterside so as not to disturb the relaxation and recreation of others.

Anglers have a fundamental interest in protecting the environment, natural resources and fish stocks of the waters, thus they should regard it as their duty to keep their angling site clean and to take part in the environmental work of the fishery waters and the association they belong to.

The most important ethical rules according to the national rules of angling:

- The angler has a moral and ethical duty to help other anglers, to share experiences, and to support older anglers and children.
- The pursuit of angling must not unduly endanger or disturb other anglers.
- Fishing boats and fishing vessels must be used at a suitable speed and without endangering or disturbing other anglers and water users.
- During the spawning and breeding season, all anglers have a responsibility to lower the speed of their vessel in the shoreline zone in order to protect as far as possible any deposited spawn or fry.
- Causing undue injury or suffering to fish is prohibited.
- During the species-specific closed season, targeting protected or spawning species and undersized specimens of fish species protected by size restriction is unethical and prohibited. If a series of undersized fish or species subject to a size or species-specific prohibition are hooked at a particular angling site, the fishing method or, if need be, the angling site should be changed in order to protect the fish population.



- It is the individual responsibility of every angler to use fishing tackle and equipment appropriate to the chosen target fish, ensuring fish welfare, and to remain in a physical condition suitable for fishing throughout the entire period spent angling.
- Leaving fishing rods that are in use unattended during angling or entrusting their supervision to others is prohibited. A fishing rod is considered to be supervised if the angler can immediately strike or start to play the fish within the shortest possible time after noticing a visual bite indication or hearing an audible bite alarm.
- When fishing for predatory fish, allowing unduly prolonged swallowing after biting is prohibited.
- Adding more hooks than the fixing points of ready-made lures permit, fixing another hook under a hook or modifying it for the purpose of facilitating external hooking is prohibited.
- With the exception of the use of lures, the use of treble hooks, wire leaders and gaffs is only allowed with the permission of the fishery operator.
- Marking in any way or mutilating the fish caught is prohibited.
- The reporting of catches of fish with an official fish tag is in the joint interest of the angler and the fishery operator. The fish tag may only be removed in the case of a lawful catch (when the fish is intended to be taken away), but in this case reporting the catch is obligatory.
- The use of wire baskets (except for bullhead) and built metal keepnets (cages) for keeping fish in is prohibited.
- When taking angling photographs, care should be taken to ensure that the photographs are aesthetically pleasing and show respect for the fish. The background of a good photograph should be the natural environment of the water and the waterside with no discarded equipment, cigarettes, food and drink, hand towels or litter visible. The angler should preferably hold the fish kneeling on one knee or both knees, or crouching; or at chest height and horizontally above the fish cradle or unhooking mat, but only part of the crib to protect the fish should be visible in the photograph. Excessively projecting the fish towards the lens is not aesthetic: the correct distance is half an arm's length to help support the weight. The fish should be clean, so any mud, grass, slime or possibly blood should be washed off with clean water. It is advisable to take several shots to obtain a photograph not affected by blinking and/or the movements of the fish. An ethical photograph cannot be taken with a cigarette in the mouth or holding the fish with a cloth. In sunny conditions, it should be noted that, if the angler is wearing a hat, the face will remain shaded unless a flash is used. When taking photographs, special care should be taken to handle and move the fish gently, as large specimens are more sensitive to being dropped and pressure than average-sized fish. Protecting the fish is the most important consideration; if professional and speedy photography is not possible, the fish must be released immediately.
- Fish not to be kept may only be photographed as a display in exceptional circumstances when scoring an angling tournament, or with the fishery operator's specific permission.
- Reporting a record catch with a fish caught by someone else is unethical and prohibited.



- The use of coloured disinfectants is only supported after photography. At this time, disinfecting all visible wounds on the fish and removing any parasites are recommended.
- Fish should only be released when they are able to maintain their equilibrium position on their own and their movement (release reflex) has started.
- The exchange or transfer of or giving away fish caught and kept in the course of angling (in closed waters, at the waterside or at the angling site) and the sale of fish caught is prohibited. Exchange means when the fish is already in a keepnet (or in the case of predators on a stringer) and the angler wishes to exchange it at the angling site for a fish caught later. Transfer means the free transfer of fish to another person who is also authorised to fish and is fishing. Giving away means transferring fish to a person who is not authorised to fish. Sale means the transfer of fish for consideration irrespective of who receives the fish.

4. BASIC FISHING METHODS

Under the Fish Act:

Angling means the recreational catching of fish in fishery waters and fish production facilities in the manner and with the set of fishing tackle permitted by this Act and its implementing decree, or a live bait lifting net not larger than 1 square metre;

Fishing set means tackle for the purpose of angling and suitable for catching fish, consisting of at least a fishing rod and line and equipped with at most three hooks.

Fishing methods can be categorised as follows, depending on the use of rods, lines, bait and lures, casting of bait, etc.

4.1. Float fishing methods

These methods use a float on the surface of the water to indicate that a fish is taking the bait. The float also holds the bait at the desired depth in the water column.

4.1.1. Whip fishing

This is a simple method of fishing, typically for beginners, or small fish and baitfish, but it is also a popular and effective competitive method due to its speed. Due to the light weight and small diameter of the shorter rods, it can also be practised by young children who are beginners. One end of the line is attached to the tip-top at the tapered end of the rod (3, 4, 5, 6, 7 m long), while the other end of the line is tied to the leader or directly to a small hook. The typically light, delicate float is usually balanced by a few pieces of shot. The finished rig is a forearm shorter than the length of the rod, making it convenient for fishing small fish as the rod bends under the weight of the fish enabling small fish to be swung to hand. Playing larger fish with this tackle takes some practice and, naturally, a landing net is needed to remove them from the water.



4.1.2. Using rod, reel and float

4.1.2.1. Fishing with a Bolognese rod

The characteristic Bolognese rod is 4 to 9 metres long, thin, lightweight, and is fitted with a reel, guides and a float. It can be used for precise fishing from one spot in standing water or for trotting in running water. The light weight of the rod is important due to its length as is the fine rig (0.12-0.18 mm line).

4.1.2.2. Fishing with a match rod

A match rod is typically between 3.6 and 4.5 metres long and is a thin but powerful fishing rod with many guides. It is suitable for medium distance float fishing with a fine rig mainly in standing water. It can be used for long distance fishing with a stick (pencil) or bulbous float or a waggler. The weight of some types of waggles can be adjusted with screw-on elements. When the rig enters the water, the line must submerge in order to maintain direct contact.

4.1.2.3. Other classic float fishing methods

- float fishing for bream and carp by the lift method in deep water
- float fishing for carp among reeds by laying on, with strong rigs from a boat
- predatory fishing with a free floating or bottom fixed float
- ice fishing for predatory and herbivorous fish
- catfish angling with a surface float (dumbbell float, giant antenna float)

4.1.3. Pole float fishing

A pole is a lightweight rod made of several sections that slot together (not telescopic), which is typically over 10 metres long. A pole is similar in appearance to a stiff, strong whip rod, but how it works and its use are quite different. The rigid pole alone would not be suitable to cushion the fight of the fish, so the end of the pole is fitted with a gently pre-stretched elastic, to which the much shorter rig is attached. The elastic, which can stretch considerably, helps when playing the fish. At the end of playing the fish, the long pole can be shortened by moving it backwards and disconnecting sections of the pole so that the fish can be landed with a part of the pole that is about the same length as the line and the stretchable elastic and much shorter than the full length of the pole. A roller rest aids moving the long pole backwards. The advantage of pole fishing is the very high precision of feeding and the ability to hold the rig in the swim accurately for a long time, which makes it a characteristic competition method. Surprisingly large fish can be caught by pole fishing, making this a popular recreational fishing technique in waters where fish weighing several kilos are often enticed close to the waterside by groundbaiting.

4.2. Bottom fishing methods

In these methods, the rig is lowered with a weight to the bottom of the water, where the bait is offered, and the fish taking the bait is signalled by the movement of the rod or line or the bite indicator. The advantage is that it is easier to fish with relatively short rods at a much greater distance and in running or deep water. The disadvantage is the reduced sensitivity of the bite signal.



4.2.1. Traditional bottom fishing methods

With the help of a weight (lead, feeding cage, Tyrolean stick, etc.), a rod and reel can be used to cast the rig, which can have 1, 2 or 3 hooks, over a long distance. After the rig has been cast and the line tightened, a bite alarm is put on the line or an electronic bite alarm is used. Depending on the type of rig and the method used, the baited hook may float on the bottom of the water or directly above it.

Such traditional bottom fishing methods are:

- classic feeder cage fishing for carp and bream;
- classic bottom fishing for predatory fish from the waterside;
- classic bottom fishing for predatory fish from a boat.

4.2.2. Boilie fishing

This method takes its name from the special, large, high-energy, high-protein bait which was originally made by boiling. The method, which is still evolving rapidly, is usually used for catching large fish (carp, grass carp) and, after photographing them with careful handling, releasing the fish. It is characterised by a strong, heavy-duty rod, a high-capacity, good quality reel, a strong line and special rigs. Boilie fishing is usually done as a campaign over a period of several days, during which bait is used to lure large fish to a location thought to be suitable. Often long distances have to be reached, so, where the operator permits this, the boilies are often spread from a boat or by a remote-controlled baitboat rather than by casting.

4.2.3. Feeder fishing

This is a bottom method where one or more hooks are placed next to a feeder cage and/or sliding ledger, and the taking fish is indicated by the quivering of the changeable coloured tip of the rod, the sensitivity of which varies. A sensitive, fine line and special rigs are used, which enable fish to be caught even at greater distances. The sensitive rod tips react to the slightest movement. Feeder rods are available in light, medium and heavy versions, and their length generally ranges from 3.3 to 4.2 metres. A special feature of the method is that the rod is placed at a 45 degree angle to the waterside, as this locks the rod and line at an angle that helps to ensure a good bite signal. In running water, especially in strong currents, the same position is achieved with the rod pointing steeply upwards, which is more favourable because less of the line in the water is caught in the current.

4.2.4. Picker fishing

This is very similar to the feeder method, but a much more subtle bottom fishing method, where the bite is likewise indicated by the quivering of the tip of the rod. The difference lies in the length of the picker rod (2.1 to 3 metres), its softer and more flexible body and the rig. The more flexible body of the rod tends to tire the fish more during playing, but this, combined with the shorter length of the rod, also means that larger fish are much less manageable. Its casting weight is lighter, typically 10 to 40 g, which limits the casting range and the rig that can be used. Fishing with a picker rod is rarely beyond 30 to 40 metres, and it is common to use lead as a weight and bait is dispersed separately with a catapult. Its sensitivity makes it an excellent



ream fishing method and, in windy weather, it is often a good substitute for float fishing, which is problematic at such times.

4.3. Fishing with lures

In these methods, artificial bait is released and moved in the water to imitate the fish's food or rival, thus exploiting its foraging or territorial instinct to make the fish attack.

4.3.1. Spin fishing

This is an active form of fishing where the angler, from a boat, the shore or standing in the water, pulls the cast bait backwards with the help of the spinning reel and moves it with the spinning rod near the perceived or known location of the fish to be caught. Excellent for sport fishing targeting predatory fish. In addition to its ultra-light version for perch and trout, it is also suitable for catching pike, zander and large catfish. A lure can also be trolled from a boat.

Tackle:

- *wobblers* (one- or two-piece lures imitating a fish and equipped with 2 single, double or treble hooks; there are surface, midwater and deep versions);
- *twisters, plastic fish* (soft PVC forms on a weighted hook and a characteristic movement);
- *spinners* (spinners or spoons, made of metal, natural or coloured, triple-hooked lures)

4.3.2. Fly fishing

A classic sport fishing method whereby a very light artificial fly mounted on a tapering leader at the end of the rig is cast on a heavy fly line to the desired location with the characteristic motion of a fly rod. A spool for storing the fly line is positioned at the end of the thin, flexible fly rod. As regards balancing the rod, line and reel, sets of differing weights (3/4/5/6/7/8/9, etc.) can be combined, depending on the water to be fished and the species to be caught. With the fly fishing method, not only classic predatory fish or trout, but also a large part of the indigenous fish fauna can be fished successfully.

Methods: *dry flies* (resembling insects falling or sitting on top of the water); *wet flies* (resembling fish and insects floating below the surface of the water, imaginary flies and streamers); *nymphs* (imitations of insect larvae floating or drifting on the bottom of the riverbed).

5. FAMILIARITY WITH FISH SPECIES

Catchable indigenous species

Eel



- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 10 kg/day
- size restriction: none
- closed season: none

Roach

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 10 kg/day
- size restriction: none
- closed season: none



Rudd

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 10 kg/day
- size restriction: none
- closed season: none



Chub

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 3 kg/day
- size restriction: 25 cm
- closed season: 15 April to 31 May



Ide

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 3 kg/day
- size restriction: 20 cm
- closed season: 15 April to 31 May



Asp

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 40 cm
- closed season: 1 March to 30 April



Bleak

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 10 kg/day
- size restriction: none
- closed season: none



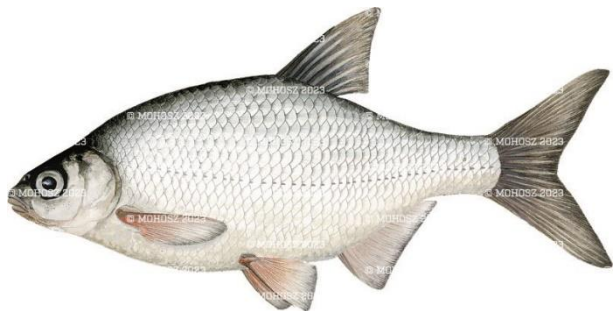
Zope

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 10 kg/day
- size restriction: none
- closed season: none



White bream

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 10 kg/day
- size restriction: none
- closed season: none



Carp bream

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 10 kg/day
- size restriction: none
- closed season: none



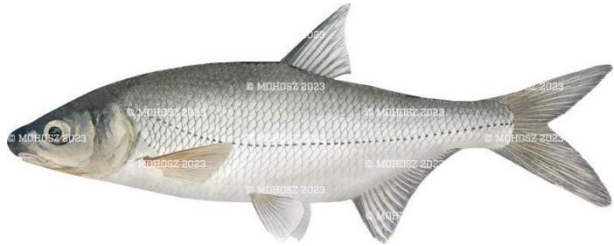
White-eye bream

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 10 kg/day
- size restriction: none
- closed season: none



Vimba bream

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 3 kg/day
- size restriction: 20 cm
- closed season: 15 April to 31 May



Sneep

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 3 kg/day
- size restriction: 20 cm
- closed season: 15 April to 31 May



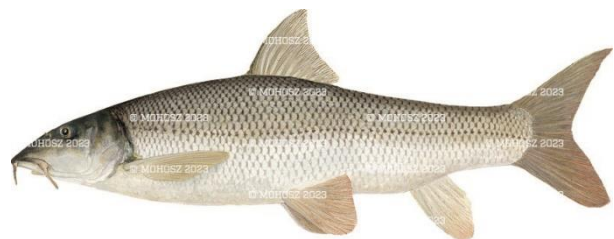
Ziege

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 3 kg/day
- size restriction: 20 cm
- closed season: 15 April to 31 May



Barbel

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 40 cm
- closed season: 15 April to 31 May



Tench

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 25 cm
- closed season: 2 May to 15 June



Common carp

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 30 cm
- closed season: 2 May to 31 May



Wels catfish

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 60 cm
- closed season: 2 May to 15 June



Pike

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 40 cm
- closed season: 1 February to 31 March



Brown trout

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 22 cm
- closed season: 1 October to 31 March



Burbot

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 3 kg/day
- size restriction: 25 cm
- closed season: none



Perch

- not protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 3 kg/day
- size restriction: 15 cm
- closed season: 1 March to 30 April



Zander

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 30 cm
- closed season: 1 March to 30 April



Volga pikeperch

- protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day
- size restriction: 25 cm
- closed season: 1 March to 30 June



Major non-indigenous species from the aspect of angling

Species not protected by restrictions on the number of fish, the total weight, size or a closed season but for which rules for catching may be laid down under local regulations.

Grass carp



Rainbow trout



Largemouth bass



Non-indigenous invasive species

Species not protected by restrictions on the number of fish, the total weight, size or a closed season but which must not be released back into water after being caught.

Prussian carp



Bullhead species (brown and black bullheads)



Bighead carp (silver carp and bighead carp)



Pumpkinseed



Stone moroko



Amur sleeper



Species that must not be caught except under a temporary exemption

Species that are not protected but must not be caught, and accidental catches must be immediately and humanely released. However, the fisheries authority may permit catching them on certain conditions.

Sterlet

- non-catchable species
- the fisheries authority may permit catching between 1 June and 28 February at the request of fishery operators, and in such cases it is protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day, size restriction: 50 cm



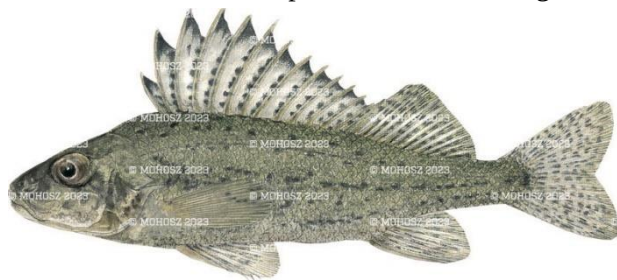
Crucian carp

- non-catchable species
- the fisheries authority may permit catching between 1 June and 28 February at the request of fishery operators, and in such cases, it is protected by number restriction, total allowable catch: 2 fish/day, size restriction: 20 cm



Ruffe

- non-catchable species whose catching even the fisheries authority cannot permit.



Species subject to nature conservation protection

Non-catchable species, and accidental catches must be immediately and humanely released. The fisheries authority cannot permit catching them even temporarily.

Ukrainian brook lamprey



Carpathian brook lamprey



Great sturgeon



Russian sturgeon



Bastard sturgeon



Starry sturgeon



Danube roach



Common dace



Barbel species (Biharian barbel and Mediterranean barbel Petényi)



European mudminnow



Eurasian minnow



Belica



Spirlin



European bitterling



Gudgeon



White-finned gudgeon



Danubian longbarbel gudgeon



Kessler's gudgeon



European weatherfish



Spined loach



Balkan spined loach



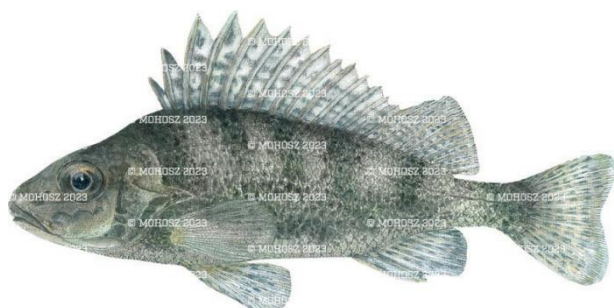
Stone loach



Bullhead



Danube ruffe



Schraetzer



Zingel



Danube streber

